Draft resolution proposed by Director Engelsman

RESOLUTION No. XXXX

Sports for Creston Elementary graduates attending Hosford Middle School

RECITALS

A. WHEREAS, Portland Public Schools (PPS) is committed to student success and equitable access to ensure every student can reach their full potential; and

B. WHEREAS, Sports in middle school are crucial for physical health, social development, academic performance, and personal growth; and

C. WHEREAS, Creston Elementary School ("Creston") 5th grade graduates do not all go to the same PPS middle school. Specifically, a small number of Creston 5th grade graduates are split from their elementary school friends and relationships of six years and tracked to attend Hosford Middle School ("Hosford") (which is a Cleveland-cluster middle school). Those students spend three years together making new friends and relationships, to then split again from their Hosford friends who are Cleveland High School ("CHS") bound. The Creston students then attend Franklin High School ("Franklin"); and

D. WHEREAS, in the 2025-2026 year, there were Creston graduates who wanted to stay after school at Hosford to participate in sports practice at Hosford with their Hosford friends, but were denied that chance. Those sports include, but are not limited to, cross-country, volleyball, basketball, track and field.

E. WHEREAS, many of those Creston students are documented to have opted OUT of sports because they are not permitted to play sports at Hosford with their new middle school friends, the same students they see in school the day before and after sports practice. Instead, they have to play at a different middle school (one which is a Franklin cluster middle school) with students they do not know and do not get to see the next day at middle school; and

F. WHEREAS, those Creston students cannot simply stay after school at Hosford, but instead must get to a different middle school in order to attend practice. This causes transportation issues and cost problems for families and PPS; and

G. WHEREAS, middle school sports was discussed during the SouthEast Guiding Coalition ("SEGC") process and families were promised that the boundaries would be resolved before their students got to high school; and

H. WHEREAS, Participation in sports ensures that middle school students engage in regular physical activity, which is essential for overall health and well-being. Sports help improve cardiovascular fitness, strength, coordination, and flexibility, while also promoting long-term

healthy habits. Establishing these habits early can reduce the risk of obesity and other lifestyle-related health issues.

I. WHEREAS, Research indicates a positive link between sports participation and academic performance. Middle school athletes often achieve higher GPAs and have a greater likelihood of graduating high school, tying directly into one of the PPS Board of Education goals. Physical activity may enhance brain function through increased blood flow, which supports concentration, memory, and learning. Additionally, sports cultivate skills such as goal-setting, discipline, and perseverance, which translate into classroom success, directly tying to PPS Board of Education goals.

J. WHEREAS, Sports provide a structured environment for students to develop social skills, teamwork, and communication. Working together toward a common goal teaches collaboration, conflict resolution, and empathy. Being part of a team also fosters self-esteem, confidence, and a sense of belonging, helping students navigate the social challenges of adolescence. Inclusive sports programs allow students of all skill levels to participate, promoting mutual respect and good sportspersonship.

K. WHEREAS, Middle school sports offer opportunities for leadership development. Students can serve as team captains, mentor peers, and demonstrate accountability, which builds self-confidence and responsibility. Time management and decision-making skills are also strengthened, as students balance practices, games, and academic responsibilities. These skills are valuable for future academic, professional, and personal endeavors.

L. WHEREAS, Engaging in sports supports mental health by reducing stress, improving mood, and fostering resilience. Students who participate in athletics are less likely to engage in risky behaviors and more likely to adopt a healthy lifestyle. The sense of achievement and camaraderie gained from sports contributes to emotional stability and overall well-being.

M. WHEREAS, Research from the Women's Sports Foundation shows that girls who play sports are more likely to hold leadership roles later in life. Skills like teamwork (73%), learning from mistakes (53%), handling pressure (51%), and pushing physical boundaries (46%) are directly transferable to careers and civic life. Even without professional play, sport participation builds a "leadership pipeline" that benefits society and the economy.

N. WHEREAS, Sport participation helps girls build stronger bones, reducing th
risk of osteoporosis later in life. Weight-bearing activities can increase bone mineral density by up to 10%, which significantly lowers fracture risk.It also supports cardiovascular health, weight management, and overall fitness.

O. WHEREAS**,** Girls who play sports report lower rates of depression and anxiety, improved self-esteem, and better body image. The structure, social support, and sense of achievement in sports provide protective factors during adolescence and into adulthood.
WHEREAS, Sports foster belonging, confidence, and positive social connections. They also help

girls develop problem-solving skills, adaptability, and the ability to work in diverse teams—qualities essential in any profession.

P. WHEREAS, Despite these benefits, girls drop out of sports at twice the rate of boys by age 14, often due to cost, lack of access, and social barriers. Ensuring equitable opportunities—through affordable programs, safe facilities, and supportive coaching—is critical to maximizing these benefits for all girls.

RESOLUTION

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, the Board of Education directs the Superintendent to:

1. For the 2026-2027 school year, allow Creston Elementary School graduates who attend Hosford Middle School but are in the Franklin High School cluster to choose whether they would like to play sports for Cleveland High School or Franklin High School.